

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20250

DEPARTMENTAL REGULATION	NUMBER: DR 1070-001
SUBJECT: U.S. Department of Agriculture Policy Statement on Climate Change Adaptation	DATE: May 26, 2021
OPI: Office of the Secretary	EXPIRATION DATE: May 26, 2026

1. PURPOSE

This Departmental Regulation (DR) provides guidance on the establishment and periodic revision of the United States Department of Agriculture's (USDA) *Climate Change Adaptation Plan*.

Climate change poses a significant risk to the agriculture and forestry sectors and the communities that support and depend upon them. Through climate adaptation planning and implementation, USDA will identify how climate change is likely to affect its ability to achieve its mission, operations, and policy and program objectives. Climate change adaptation is a critical complement to mitigation; both are required to address the causes and consequences of climate change. Through climate adaptation planning, USDA will develop, prioritize, implement, and evaluate actions to minimize climate risks, and exploit new opportunities that climate change may bring. By integrating climate change adaptation strategies into USDA's programs and operations, USDA better ensures that taxpayer resources are invested wisely, and that USDA services and operations remain effective under current and future climate conditions. Through climate adaptation planning, USDA is taking a leadership role in ensuring the vision of a resilient, healthy, and prosperous Nation in the face of a changing climate.

2. ACTIONS ORDERED

This policy establishes the USDA directive to integrate climate change adaptation planning, implementing actions, and performance metrics into USDA programs, policies, and operations in accordance with executive orders and additional guidance from CEQ.

- a. The Chief Economist, with the full support and participation of USDA Mission Areas, agencies, and staff offices, will:

- (1) Develop a *USDA Climate Change Adaptation Plan* in accordance with Departmental and Inter-agency guidance;

- (2) Issue guidance to Mission Areas, agencies, and staff offices to complete or update their climate adaptation plans, as well as required interim deliverables; and
 - (3) Update the *USDA Climate Change Adaptation Plan* as appropriate and provide progress reports on the status of implementation efforts annually.
- b. USDA Mission Area, agency, and staff office heads, in developing organization-specific contributions, will:
 - (1) Analyze how climate change may affect the ability of their organization to achieve its mission and policy, program, and operational objectives and authorities to:
 - (a) Identify potential impacts of climate change on their organization's areas of responsibility;
 - (b) Prioritize, implement, and integrate response actions into their Mission Area's, agency's, or staff office's operation, contingent on the availability of resources;
 - (c) Continuously assess and improve the capacity to adapt to current and future changes in the climate; and
 - (d) Prepare contributions to the Department's *Climate Change Adaptation Plan*.
 - (2) Identify, as appropriate, key performance measures to evaluate progress in climate change adaptation in the annual Departmental and Mission Area, agency, and staff office budget material, to include measures in the Summary of Budget and Performance section of the explanatory notes, submitted as part of the Congressional justification.
 - (a) Identify, to the extent possible, the costs associated with the accomplishment of Mission Area, agency, or staff office performance measures and provide accessible information to producers; and
 - (b) Identify returns to Mission Area, agency, or staff office end-users for climate adaptation actions in terms of a list of expected accomplishments.
 - (3) Identify, as part of the annual budget process, to the Office of Budget and Program Analysis (OBPA), areas where budget adjustments would be necessary to carry out actions identified under this DR.
 - (4) Identify, as appropriate, for USDA's Office of the General Counsel, areas where legal analysis is needed to carry out actions identified under this DR; and
 - (5) Identify the point of contact and coordinate actions with USDA's Global Change Task Force, as appropriate.

- 1 c. USDA Mission Areas, agencies, and staff offices will integrate information that reflects
2 the current understanding of global climate change and its projected impacts when
3 undertaking long-term planning exercises, setting priorities for scientific research and
4 investigations, developing performance metrics, and making decisions affecting Mission
5 Area, agency, or staff office resources, programs, and operations.
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8 3. EFFECTIVE DATE AND TERMINATION
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- 10 a. The provisions of this DR are effective immediately and will remain in effect until
11 superseded or revoked.
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13 b. This policy supersedes and replaces DR 1070-001, *U.S. Department of Agriculture*
14 *(USDA) Policy Statement on Climate Change Adaptation*, dated June 15, 2015.
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19 /s/ THOMAS J. VILSACK
20 SECRETARY OF AGRICULTURE
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